

Activity Guide

How the HMF Design Clinic works

A hands-on team exercise. Your team acts as Cisco Solution Engineers for a real-feeling customer, Cedarline Health Group. You read their situation, then work four use cases — for each one you answer the customer's concerns with the right Cisco product and a short Solution-Engineer explanation of how it helps.

What you do, start to finish

- Form a team. Pick a team name and list your members.
- Read the customer scenario with your team.
- Work the four use cases in order: 1) AI Security, 2) Cloud Edge, 3) DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall, 4) Macro & Micro Segmentation.
- For each concern, write two things: the product / platform that solves it, and a Solution-Engineer response — how it addresses the concern and how it helps Cedarline.
- Hand your workbook to the proctor. Each use case is scored out of 100; four make 400.

How to write a good answer

- Name a **product**, not a category. “Cisco Secure Firewall with the Encrypted Visibility Engine,” not “a firewall.”
- Make the reasoning specific to Cedarline — their real constraints: no decrypting clinical traffic, segmentation that died on ~10,000 hand-written rules, only two firewall engineers, three cloud policy models.
- Say how it **helps** — the outcome for the customer, not just the feature.
- A product name with no reasoning scores low. Reasoning true for any customer scores in the middle. Reasoning that turns on something Cedarline said scores high.

REMEMBER Half the marks are the reasoning. The best answers sound like they could only have been written for Cedarline.